



Introducing the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology II

In line with the maxim that a picture is worth a thousand words, images of renal histology and pathology anchor our understanding of kidney function and disease. Accordingly, it is vital that nephrologists are familiar with pathologic correlates of clinical presentations and have access to reference images for pathologic conditions, especially those that are seen only rarely at most institutions. With this in mind, in 1998, Dr Neil Kurtzman, Editor-in-Chief of *AJKD* at the time, envisioned and supported the launch of the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology (www.ajkd.org/content/atlasofrenalpathology2). Over the next 5 years, over 50 installments highlighted key renal pathology features, including light microscopy, immunofluorescence, and electron microscopy, and provided freely accessible, high-quality, downloadable images on the breadth of kidney conditions. The Atlas has become both a popular reference and a valuable resource, directing and guiding a generation of nephrologists and students aiming to understand the structure behind the disease. Users have ranged from remote developing countries to top medical centers, with images used for teaching presentations, teaching on rounds, or to aid in evaluating and diagnosing unusual biopsies. The Atlas has been one of the most rewarding teaching endeavors with which we have been engaged.

As nearly 2 decades have passed since the original Atlas launched, and new pathologic entities and findings have emerged, this resource was due for an update. In this issue of *AJKD*, we are pleased to launch the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology II, in collaboration with Dr Mark Lusco (Vanderbilt University), Dr Behzad Najafian (University of Washington), and Dr Charles Alpers (University of Washington). Classic disease features will be reframed and updated, and information on recently recognized conditions will be added. While each installment of the original Atlas consisted of a series of images and brief explanatory legends, the new Atlas will supplement the figures with a systematic presentation of key information about each entity, broken into 4 sections: Clinical and Pathologic Features, Etiology/Pathogenesis, Differential Diagnosis, and Key Diagnostic Features. This information will synthesize the disease, the pathology, and the mechanism of injury into a concise framework to anchor the images. When complete, the new Atlas will provide a comprehensive overview of damage and injury in the kidney, as outlined in **Box 1**.

The passage of time since the original Atlas published has also occasioned profound growth in online options and functionality. As an integral journal

Box 1. Overview of the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology II

- Primary Glomerular Diseases
 - ◊ Glomerular diseases that cause nephrotic syndrome
 - ◊ Glomerular diseases that cause hematuria or nephritic syndrome
- Glomerular Manifestations of Systemic Diseases
 - ◊ Diseases associated with nephrotic syndrome
 - ◊ Diseases associated with nephritic/nephrotic syndrome or rapidly progressive glomerulonephritis
 - ◊ Diseases associated with minimal urinary abnormalities or isolated hematuria
- Vascular Diseases
- Tubulointerstitial Diseases
- Renal Transplantation

feature, the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology II will be accessible through the journal website (www.ajkd.org), the ScienceDirect platform, and ClinicalKey, the clinical search engine from Elsevier. The content will also be contained in the journal's iOS and Android mobile apps. In addition, the *AJKD* Blog (www.ajkdblog.org) will allow for new opportunities to refine and expand the mission of the Atlas. Taking advantage of the capabilities of the blog, the new Atlas will provide context, self-assessment, and ancillary materials that go beyond the images. From foundational material like understanding the dynamic nature of pathology findings and the approach to reviewing renal histology, to deeper discussions on the formation of crescents, the structure of spikes, and the antigens in glomerulonephritides, Atlas II will explore the vibrant world of renal pathology.

As with the original Atlas, the new installments will be MEDLINE indexed and free to access at AJKD.org. All images will be available to download as PowerPoint slides that can be used for a personal, noncommercial library of images or to create materials for teaching purposes. With the exception of the first installment on minimal change disease,¹ each addition to Atlas II will be published as an online-only article, including 5 additional installments published as part of this issue.²⁻⁶ Related materials to expand the educational opportunities of installments will appear on the *AJKD* Blog on an ongoing basis.

Address correspondence to Agnes B. Fogo, MD, Department of Pathology, Microbiology and Immunology, Vanderbilt University Medical Center, MCN C3310, Nashville, TN 37232. E-mail: agnes.fogo@vanderbilt.edu

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We look forward to the *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology II expanding the educational mission of the Journal.

Agnes B. Fogo, MD

Editor, *AJKD* Atlas of Renal Pathology (I & II)
Vanderbilt University, Nashville, Tennessee

Scott J. Gilbert, MD¹

Andrew S. Levey, MD²

¹Education Editor and ²Editor-in-Chief, *AJKD*
Tufts Medical Center, Boston, Massachusetts

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